that time. Verma called him at 1 a.m. He clearly stated that the tracking team had to wait till his arrival in Bangalore. He did not think there was any chance of catching Sivarasan alive, even if the raid was conducted right away. Verma, who used to report to Karan in the CBI, tried to convince him about the urgency of the situation, but to no avail.[7]

There was no way the fugitives could be driven out of the house. Their hideouts were always well stocked with food and water that could see them through weeks. They had kept all the doors and windows closed. If Rangan had returned to their hideout in the evening, there was a small chance that they might have made an attempt to escape. But by then, the city police had surrounded the house. While it looked like the tracking team was about the strike, the order was to wait. The commissioner of police, Ramalingam, did not agree with the instant raid. He felt it would lead to massive casualties among his men, thanks to the AK-47 rifles and 9-mm pistols the fugitives were carrying. Also, he would not move without a green signal from Delhi. Earlier he had said that the tracking team had no jurisdictional authority and had to cooperate with the Bangalore Police for the strike. Now he said he needed orders from the higher-ups in Delhi. The tracking team felt helpless. No one was even allowing them to try and catch Sivarasan alive.[8]

The plan chalked out by the Black Cats appeared promising, but they, too, could not do anything without their seniors' nod. And there were too many seniors calling the shots—including Vijay Karan from Delhi and Kaarthikeyan from Hyderabad. Kaarthikeyan was home at that critical phase of the chase. Then there was the commissioner of the Bangalore Police and Radhavinod Raju from Malligai.

The night-long vigil continued till the next day. The presence of policemen and their vehicles surrounding the house drew the attention of the locals. People started crowding the area. Managing them required a full-fledged police team. But no one was willing to miss the drama. Word went around that Rajiv Gandhi's killers had been traced. Despite requests, the DCP Traffic refused to cordon off the area and keep traffic at bay. The tracking team could not understand how an operation of that magnitude was possible with such immense public presence. In the meantime,